

Section 9.2 Community and tradition

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — Anglican Churches, apostolic, bishops, catholic, celibacy, laity, New Testament, Nonconformist Churches, Old Testament, ordination, Orthodox Churches, papacy

- Why some Christians believe the Bible is the direct word of God.
- Why some Christians believe the Bible was written by humans about their experiences of God.
- Why the Bible has authority and importance for Christians.
- The meaning, and importance for Christians, of the Church being the means to faith and salvation.
- The meaning of the Apostolic Tradition and Succession and their importance for Roman Catholic Christians.
- The meaning of Protestant beliefs about the authority of the Church and their importance for Protestant Christians.
- Why Christians have different attitudes to the role and importance of the Virgin Mary.
- The role and importance of the Pope and bishops in the Roman Catholic Church.
- The role of the priest/minister in the local church.
- Why Christians have different attitudes to the celibacy of the clergy.
- The role and importance of a church in its local area.